

goats. What matters is that you speak the same money language as the person you choose to build a life with. And if you're serious about building a financial dynasty, there is only one language that's going to get you where you want to go. Meanies of the world, unite!

Money Mistake: *Your Partner Doesn't Speak Your Money Language*

The Fix: *Find Someone Who Does*

Even if your partner is not a mooch, spendaholic, loafer or thief, he or she may speak a foreign money language. Sometimes you will encounter "translation difficulties" of a different sort.

A few years ago, I was doing a speaking engagement at Ryerson University, and during the Q&A after the lecture, a young man raised his hand. He was a good-looking kid, though he seemed very troubled. He had dark circles under his eyes.

He told me he'd really enjoyed my talk. "I'm hoping you can help me out with something," he said, and when I asked him what was up, he told me his story.

This kid was running a financial services software company out of his dorm room and doing \$4 million in sales. If you know my business history, you'll understand why I pricked up my ears immediately. He was both exhausted and exhilarated—a combination I knew well. His business was already extremely successful and he hadn't even graduated yet. But he knew it had tremendous potential, so he was working on it day and night. I congratulated him for what sounded like some really great work, work that was going to pay off well in the future. But what was the problem?

The problem was that he had been dating a girl for four years and they had recently gotten engaged. Earlier that week, his girlfriend had stood in front of him and drawn a line in the sand. "I can't take this anymore," she said. "We don't spend any time together. I don't even see you on weekends. I'm supposedly engaged, but I'm alone all the time. It's got to change or I'm leaving you."